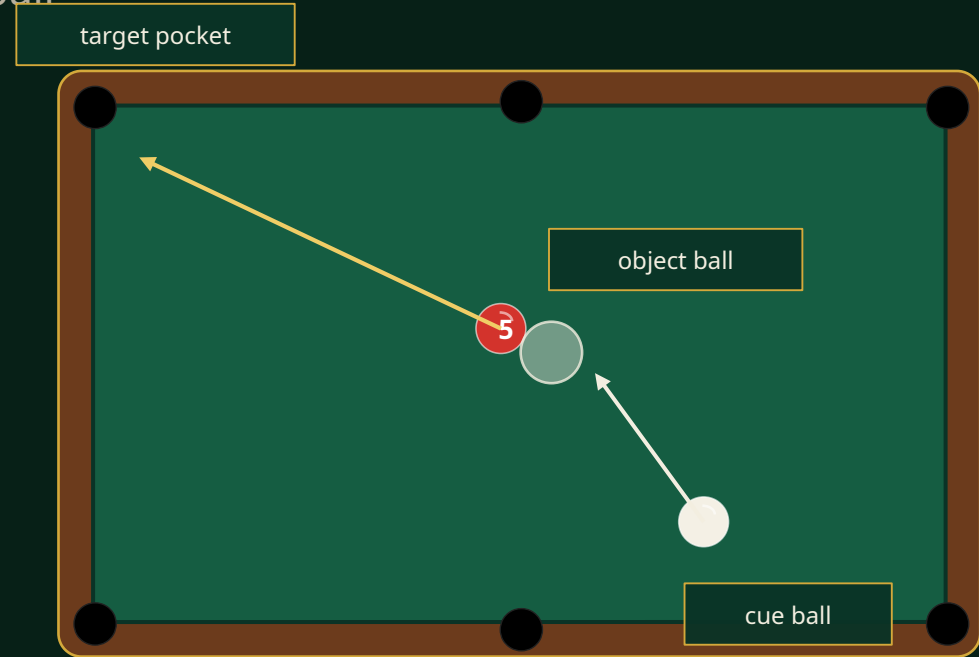


Finding the Angle

Aiming angled shots with contact point, ghost ball and cue-ball path.

The pocket you see is not the point you aim the cue ball at.

Today we connect three things: the pocket line, the object ball contact point, and where the cue ball must arrive.



Cue ball → ghost ball → object ball → pocket

Learning objectives

- 1 Identify the pocket line for an angled shot.
- 2 Explain why “aiming at the visible centre” is wrong.
- 3 Use the ghost-ball idea to locate the contact point.
- 4 Practise small, medium and larger-angle cuts safely.

Pocket line

Where the object ball must travel

Contact point

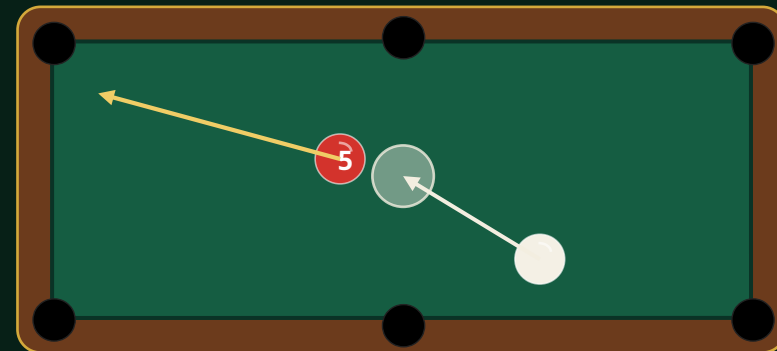
Where the balls meet

Ghost ball

Cue-ball position at impact

Cue path

How the white ball arrives



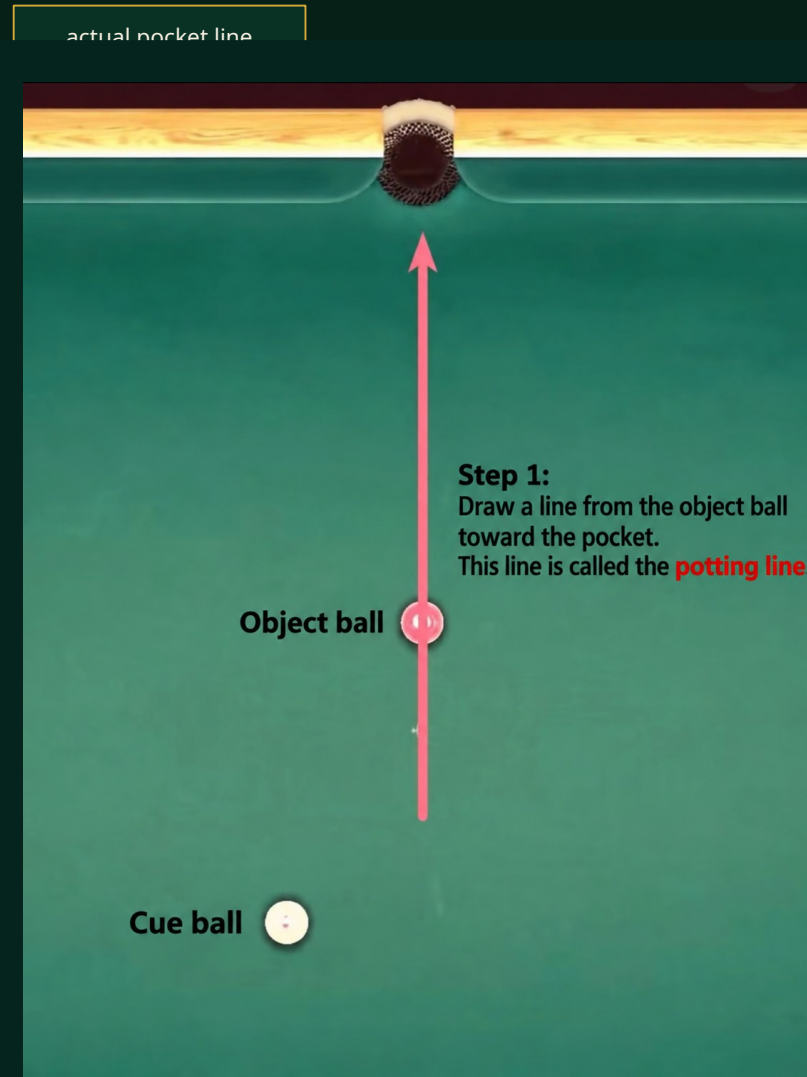
Why angled shots miss

Key idea

Read the pocket first. The object ball must travel along the potting line into the pocket.

Why this matters

If you do not fix that line first, the cut angle becomes hard to judge and angled shots are often missed.



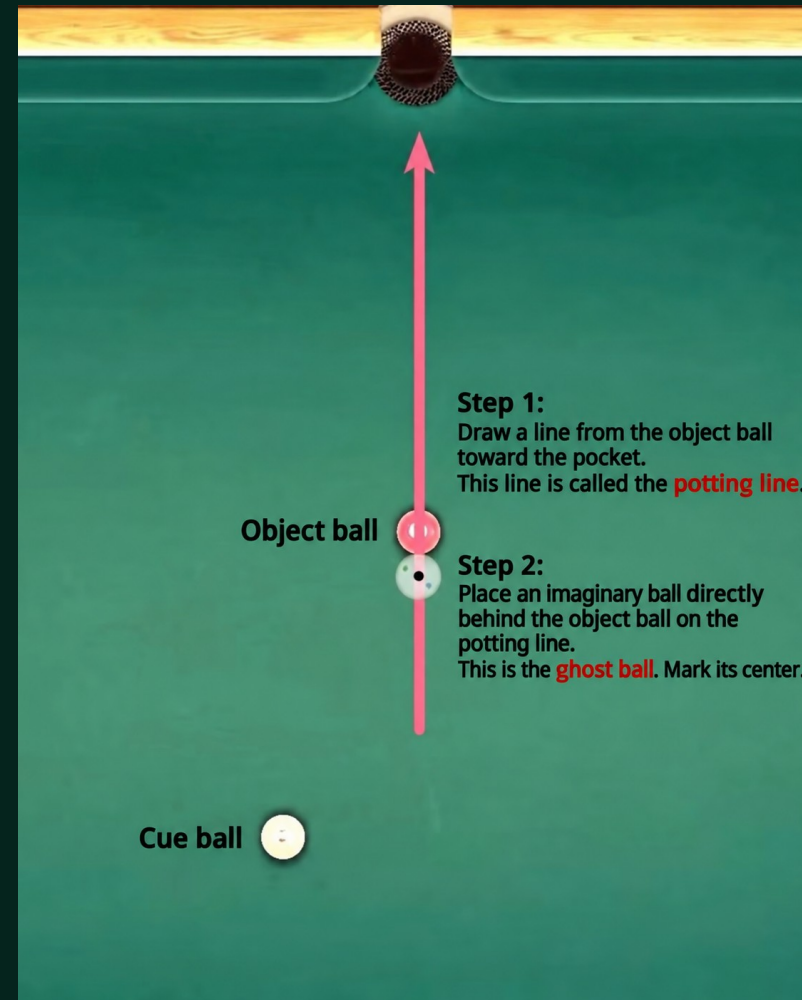
The ghost-ball method

Ghost ball

Place an imaginary cue ball directly behind the object ball on the potting line.

Contact point

The centre of that ghost ball marks the point your real cue ball must reach.



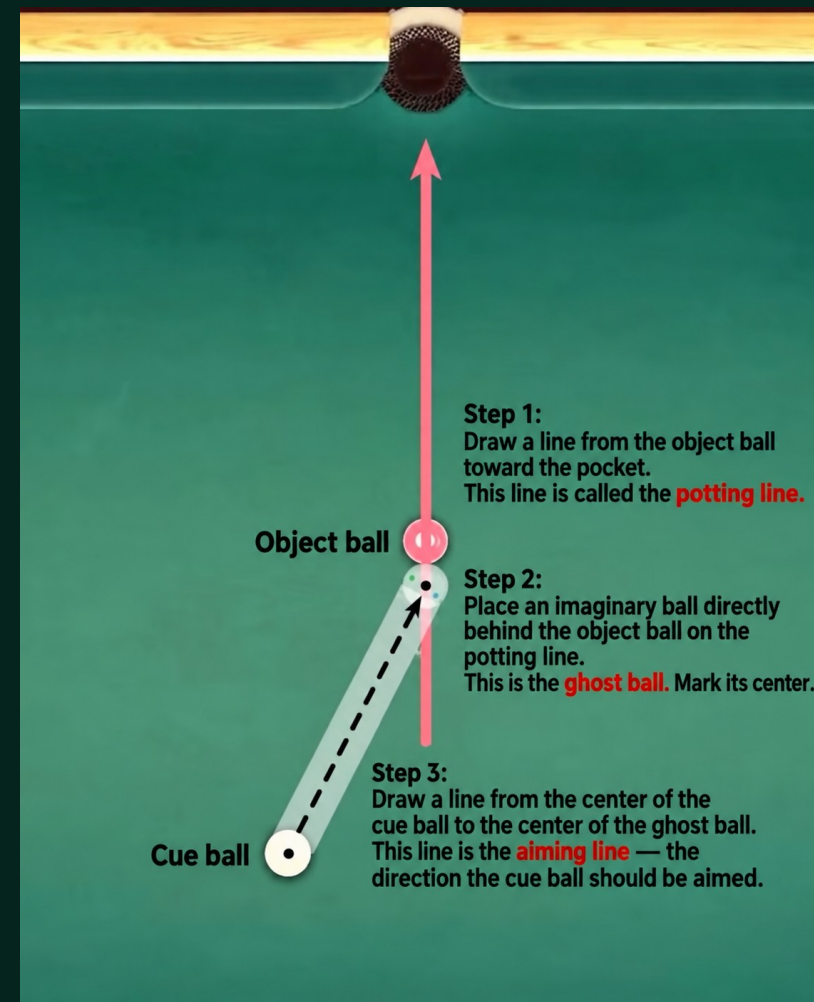
Step-by-step aiming routine

Aiming routine

1. Draw the potting line.
2. Place the ghost ball behind the object ball.
3. Draw the aiming line from cue-ball centre to ghost-ball centre.

Final action

Deliver the cue straight along that aiming line.



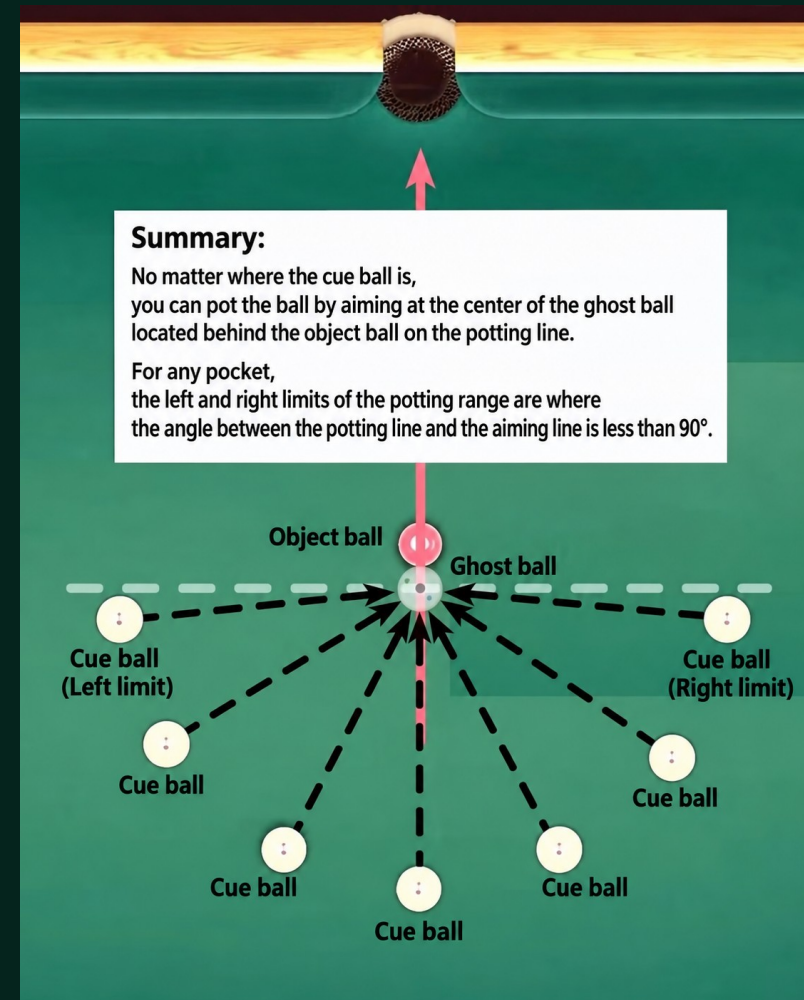
Practise angle size

Across different positions

Even when the cue ball starts from different places, the same aiming idea still works.

Practical limit

The left and right limits of the potting range are where the angle between the potting line and the aiming line stays under 90° .



Common errors to check



Standing too late

Walk into the shot from the cue-ball line; do not aim only after bending down.



Ignoring ball size

Allow for a cue-ball-width ghost position, not just a painted dot.



Aiming at object-ball centre

For an angled shot, centre-to-centre is usually the wrong contact.



Changing stroke mid-way

Decide first, then deliver smoothly through the cue ball.

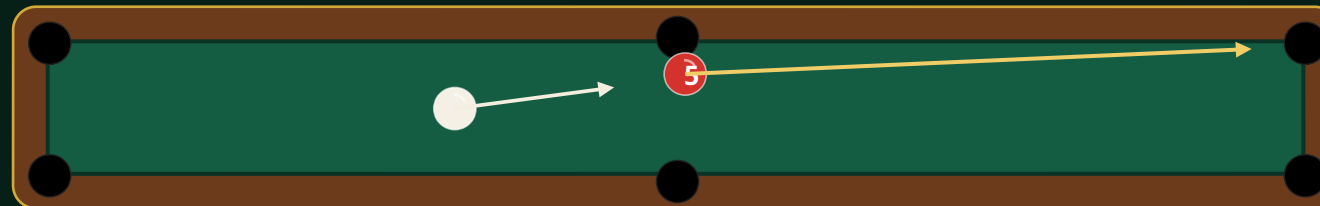
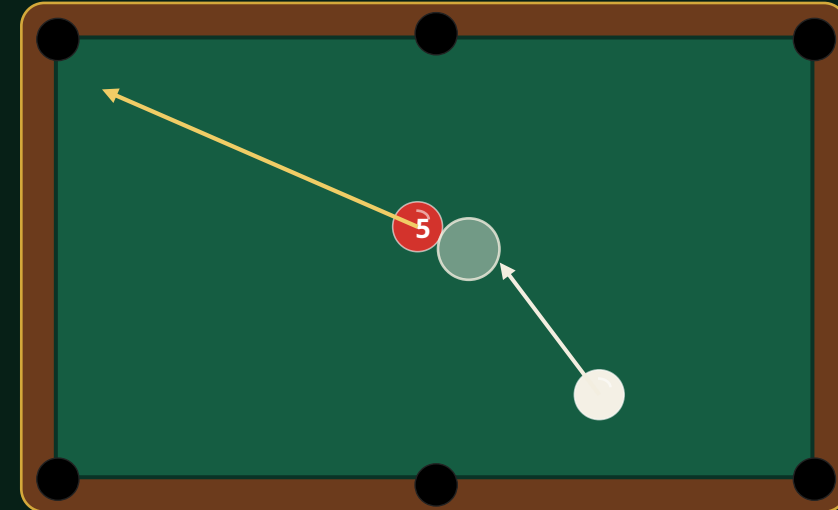


Table check

Before leaving the table, each pair should be able to explain one angled shot in full.

- ✓ Which pocket is the object ball meant to enter?
- ✓ Where is the object-ball path?
- ✓ Where does the ghost ball sit?
- ✓ Which point should the cue-ball centre travel toward?
- ✓ What changes as the cut angle becomes larger?



See it. Plan it. Play it.

Next week: using contact thickness to predict ball paths.